

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 782

By Capley

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Charles W. "Charlie" Holt, Jr.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly were greatly saddened to learn of the passing of Charles W. "Charlie" Holt, Jr., of Lawrenceburg; and

WHEREAS, Charlie Holt was born on January 4, 1951, to Charles W. Holt and Nell Holt; he diligently served the people of Lawrence County and Middle Tennessee by practicing law for nearly five decades, building a reputation as a steady and principled counselor who guided generations of families and businesses through some of their most important and difficult decisions; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Holt graduated from Middle Tennessee State University (MTSU) in 1973 and went on to briefly teach and coach football; he earned his law degree from the University of Tennessee College of Law in 1976 and was admitted to the Tennessee Bar in 1977; and

WHEREAS, while attending MTSU, Charlie Holt was a four-year starter for the Blue Raiders football team and was consistently singled out for his toughness and leadership; he earned All Ohio Valley Conference (OVC) honors for three seasons and was chosen as one of six of MTSU's Most Outstanding Seniors; and

WHEREAS, throughout his life, he always carried with him the traits that he refined during his football career: steadiness, discipline, and team-orientation; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Holt began his legal career in Smyrna but soon moved back to Lawrenceburg, where he became a central figure in the firm now known as Boston, Holt & Durham; and

WHEREAS, Charlie Holt also served as County Attorney for Lawrence County for more than thirty years, in which position he helped shape local government by providing quiet, steady advice through countless meetings, crises, and transitions; and

WHEREAS, an active member of the statewide legal community, he was a Tennessee Bar Foundation Fellow and a member of the Lawrence County Bar Association and the Tennessee Bar Association; and

WHEREAS, he was a mentor to many young attorneys, a careful listener, and someone who led by example and believed law was, at its core, a profession to serve others; and

WHEREAS, Charlie Holt was a member of the Downtown Church of Christ and later the Pulaski Street Church of Christ; he also served as President of Christian Homes, Inc., which provides resources for vulnerable members of the community; and

WHEREAS, members of these communities remember him for his calm judgment, sense of fairness, and habit of putting others first; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Holt's favorite pastimes were spending time with his family and friends, engaging in deep conversations, cheering on the MTSU Blue Raiders, spending time at the river with his wife, taking boat rides, and going on drives; and

WHEREAS, deeply devoted to his family, Mr. Holt enjoyed the loving companionship of his wife of fifty-two years, Martha, and was the proud father of Catherine "Cassie" Holt and Charles W. "Trey" Holt III; and

WHEREAS, he will be sadly mourned but fondly remembered by his wife and children; his sisters, Nelda Graham, Laura Haynes, and Sara Jane (Bill) Margraf; his nephews, Kenneth (Brenda) Smith, William Smith, and Will Haynes; his nieces, Natalee (Marc) Estrin and Rachel Haynes (Austin Cruse); his eight great-nieces and -nephews, Jack Haynes, Charlee Haynes, Lynden Estrin, Griffin Estrin, Kori Outland, Brian Smith, Jennifer (Craig) Fox, and Caley Smith;

his family at Boston, Holt & Durham; and a host of extended family members and dear friends;
and

WHEREAS, Charlie Holt leaves behind an indelible legacy of integrity and probity in public life, compassion and loyalty in private life, and diligence and dedication in all his chosen endeavors; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that we should remember the bountiful life of this exceptional public servant and human being; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of Charles W. "Charlie" Holt, Jr., reflecting fondly upon his impeccable character and his stalwart commitment to living the examined life with courage and conviction.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we extend our sympathy and offer our condolences to the family of Mr. Holt.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.